

Stjepan Picek

Curriculum Vitae

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Born: 14 March, 1984
Languages: Croatian, English, German



Experience

Academic Appointments

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| April 2026 | Received ius promovendi , Radboud University, The Netherlands. |
| April 2025–present | Full professor , University of Zagreb, Croatia.
0.7 FTE Zagreb, 0.3 FTE Radboud, 0.2 FTE Bergen |
| January 2025–present | Adjunct professor , University of Bergen, Norway.
1.0 FTE Radboud, 0.2 FTE Bergen |
| August 2024 | Elected as Full professor , University of Zagreb, Croatia. |
| October 2021–present | Associate professor , Radboud University, The Netherlands. |
| July 2017–September 2021 | Assistant professor (obtained tenure in February 2020) , <i>Cyber Security Group</i> , TU Delft, The Netherlands. |
| March 2017–June 2017 | Postdoctoral researcher , <i>CSAIL</i> , <i>Massachusetts Institute of Technology</i> , Cambridge, USA. |
| September 2015–February 2017 | Postdoctoral researcher , <i>ESAT/COSIC</i> , <i>KU Leuven</i> , Leuven, Belgium. |
| September 2013–August 2014 | PhD researcher , <i>Radboud University</i> , Nijmegen, The Netherlands. |

Industry Appointments

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| September 2025–present | Founder , <i>SecureML</i> , Zagreb, Croatia.
Startup on security of machine learning. |
| September 2014–August 2015 | Developer , <i>Ministry of Interior</i> , Zagreb, Croatia.
Security related work |
| July 2010–August 2013 | Developer , <i>Ministry of Interior</i> , Zagreb, Croatia.
Security related work |
| March 2010–June 2010 | System architect , <i>Kapsch Croatia</i> , Zagreb, Croatia.
Telecommunication sector |
| September 2007–February 2010 | Development engineer , <i>Ring Datacom</i> , Zagreb, Croatia.
Telecommunication sector |

Education

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| November 2015–October 2024 | PhD in Mathematics , <i>University of Paris 8</i> , Paris, France, Study in the field of abstract algebra and cryptography.
Supervised by prof. Claude Carlet. PhD thesis: Boolean Functions and S-boxes in Cryptography: Properties and Constructions |
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March 2008–July 2015 **Double PhD (cotutelle) in Computer Science**, *Radboud University & University of Zagreb*, Nijmegen, The Netherlands & Zagreb, Croatia, Study in the field of evolutionary computation and cryptography.
Supervised by prof. Lejla Batina, prof. Domagoj Jakobovic, and prof. Elena Marchiori.
PhD thesis: “Applications of Evolutionary Computation to Cryptology”

September 2002–December 2007 **MSc in Electrical Engineering**, *Faculty of Engineering*, Rijeka, Croatia.

Research Interests

- Cybersecurity.
- Cryptology.
- Security of machine learning.
- Machine learning.
- Evolutionary computation.
- Abstract algebra.

Honors and Recognitions

- 2026 Editorial Contribution Award 2026 for International Journal of Information Security.
- 2026 National Award for Science for 2024 given by the Republic of Croatia (awarded in 2026).
- 2026 IEEE Distinguished Contributor Recognition.
- 2026 Paper “Mind the Portability: A Warrior’s Guide through Realistic Profiled Side-channel Analysis” selected as one of the Top Picks in Hardware and Embedded Security 2026.
- 2026 Paper “Strength in numbers: Improving generalization with ensembles in machine learning-based profiled side-channel analysis” selected as one of the Top Picks in Hardware and Embedded Security 2026.
- 2025 NeurIPS 2025 Top Reviewer.
- 2024–2025 Listed in The Stanford/Elsevier Top 2% Scientist Rankings, career-long data.
- 2021–2025 Listed in The Stanford/Elsevier Top 2% Scientist Rankings.
- 2025 SaTML 2025 Outstanding Reviewer Award.
- 2025 Humies (Awards for Human-Competitive Results Produced by Genetic and Evolutionary Computation) competition finalist. GECCO, Malaga, Spain.
- 2025 Best paper award: Claude Carlet, Marko Đurasević, Domagoj Jakobovic, Stjepan Picek and Luca Mariot: A Systematic Evaluation of Evolving Highly Non-linear Boolean Functions in Odd Sizes. 28th European Conference on Genetic Programming (Part of EvoStar 2025), <https://www.evostar.org/2025/eurogp-best-paper-nominees/>.
- 2024 Outstanding Scientific Paper Award from Croatian Institute for Cyber Security for the paper “A Comprehensive Study of Jailbreak Attack versus Defense for Large Language Models”.
- 2024 Outstanding member of the IEEE TIFS Editorial Board Award.
- 2024 GECCO 2024 Outstanding Reviewer Award.
- 2024 Fellow of the Young Academy of Europe.
- 2023 IEEE Croatia Section Award for Outstanding Engineering Contributions in Artificial Intelligence and Security.

- 2023 Selected as one of 20 alumni to participate in Heidelberg Laureate Forum, Heidelberg, Germany.
- 2023 Paper “DARWIN: Survival of the Fittest Fuzzing Mutators” received Distinguished Paper Award at NDSS 2023.
- 2022 Rikard Podhorsky Annual Award from Croatian Academy of Engineering for especially valuable scientific or professional achievements, Croatia.
- 2022 Paper “Make some noise. unleashing the power of convolutional neural networks for profiled side-channel analysis” selected as Honorable Mention in Top Picks in Hardware and Embedded Security 2022.
- 2022 Selected as a member of the scientific board of the Croatian Academy of Engineering.
- 2021 Paper “The Curse of Class Imbalance and Conflicting Metrics with Machine Learning for Side-channel Evaluations” selected as one of the Top Picks in Hardware and Embedded Security 2021.
- 2021 Selected as an associate of the Croatian Academy of Engineering.
- 2020 Paper “CSI NN: Reverse Engineering of Neural Network Architectures Through Electromagnetic Side Channel” selected as one of the Top Picks in Hardware and Embedded Security 2020.
- 2020 The finals of dcypher’s Dutch Cyber Security Research Paper Award competition: “CSI NN: Reverse Engineering of Neural Network Architectures Through Electromagnetic Side Channel”.
- 2020 Humies (Awards for Human-Competitive Results Produced by Genetic and Evolutionary Computation) competition finalist. GECCO, Cancun, Mexico.
- 2020 Evostar 2020 Best paper nomination.
- 2019 Humies (Awards for Human-Competitive Results Produced by Genetic and Evolutionary Computation) competition finalist. GECCO, Prague, Czech Republic.
- 2019 Best paper award: Walter Krawec, Stjepan Picek, Domagoj Jakobovic: Evolutionary Algorithms for the Design of Quantum Protocols. International Conference on the Applications of Evolutionary Computation (Part of EvoStar) (http://www.evostar.org/2019/programme_bestpapers.php).
- 2018 PPSN 2018 Best paper nomination.
- 2018 Selected as one of 200 young scientists to participate in Heidelberg Laureate Forum, Heidelberg, Germany.
- 2017 Vera Johanides Award for the Young Scientists in Computer Science, Zagreb, Croatia.
- 2016 Humies (Awards for Human-Competitive Results Produced by Genetic and Evolutionary Computation) competition finalist. GECCO, Denver, USA.
- 2010 Best paper award: Stjepan Picek, Marin Golub: On the Efficiency of Crossover Operators in Genetic Algorithms with Binary Representation. Proceedings of the 2nd WSEAS International Conference on Evolutionary Computing, EC’10. (www.wseas.us/reports/2010/best2010.htm)

Selected Research Visits and Collaborations

- 2018–2025 **Visiting professor**, *Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computing*, Zagreb, Croatia.
- 2018–2019 **Visiting scientist**, *NTU Singapore*, Singapore.

- 2017 **Guest researcher**, *CSAIL, Massachusetts Institute of Technology*, Cambridge, USA.
 - 2018–2020 **Research fellow**, *University of Milan–Bicocca*, Milan, Italy.
 - 2017 **Free researcher**, *ESAT/COSIC, KU Leuven*, Leuven, Belgium.
 - 2015–2016 **Visiting lecturer**, *Faculty of Engineering*, Rijeka, Croatia.
- Additionally, I visited more than 20 universities for short term visits (up to one month).

Leadership

- President of IEEE CIS Croatia chapter, 2016 - 2020.

Service

Service to the Academic Community

Current:

- VinFuture Prize Official Nominator, 2026.
- Book editor for “Artificial Intelligence and Security: Recent Developments”. Springer, 2026.
- IEEE Information Forensics and Security Technical Committee member. 2025–2027.
- Associate editor for IEEE Transactions on Emerging Topics in Computing. 2024–present.
- Member of the Biometric, Forensic and Security (BForSec) Technical Area Committee of the EURAIP. 2024–present.
- Associate editor for International Journal of Information Security. 2024–present.
- Associate editor for IEEE Transactions on Information Forensics and Security. 2022–present.
- Associate editor for Journal of Cryptographic Engineering. 2022–present.
- IEEE WIFS 2026 Area Chair
- Program Committees member (selected current): EVOSTAR 2026, GECCO 2026, Asiacrypt 2026, NDSS 2027, S&P 2027.
- Steering committee member, MIPRO AIS - Artificial Intelligence Systems. 2023–present

Selected past service:

- Guest editor for IEEE Security & Privacy. 2024–2025.
- Guest editor for Cryptography and Communications. 2024–2026.
- Guest editor for IEEE Journal on Emerging and Selected Topics in Circuits and Systems special issue on Towards Trustworthy AI: Advances in Circuits, Systems, and Applications. 2024–2025.
- Guest editor for Journal of Cryptographic Engineering special issue on Machine Learning-based Side-channel Analysis. 2022–2024.
- Editorial Board, CIT. Journal of Computing and Information Technology. 2017–2023.
- Book editor for “Security and Artificial Intelligence: A Crossdisciplinary Approach”. Springer, 2022.
- Guest editor for ACM Journal on Emerging Technologies in Computing Systems special issue on Trustworthy AI, 2022.

- Management Committee member COST Action IC1403–Cryptanalysis of ubiquitous computing systems (CRYPTACUS).
- Management Committee member COST Action IC1204–Trustworthy Manufacturing and Utilization of Secure Devices (TRUDEVICE).
- Program Chair: SPACE 2020-2022 (Conference on Security, privacy, applied cryptography, and cryptographic engineering)

Journals:

- Journal referee: Neural Computing and Applications; Science China Information Sciences; Journal of Heuristics; IEEE Transactions on Evolutionary Computation; IEEE Transactions on Information Forensics & Security; IEEE Transactions on Cybernetics; IEEE Transactions on VLSI; Design, Codes and Cryptography; Cryptography and Communications; Genetic Programming and Evolvable Machines; Journal of Advanced Research; Journal of Cryptographic Engineering, Computer Journal; Journal of Algebra Combinatorics Discrete Structures and Applications, Theoretical Computer Science.

Research Organizations:

- Proposal evaluator: Research Council of Norway; Research Grant Council, Hong Kong; Qatar Research, Development, and Innovation Council; Belgian Defense Call; French National Research Agency; Israel Science Foundation; National Research, Development and Innovation Office, Hungary

Event Organization

- Beyond Conventional Hardware Security: Next-Generation Design and Security Evaluation for Hardware Architectures. Organizer of a Focus Session (Hot-Topic) at DATE 2026.
- AIHWS 2026. Organizer of an affiliated event at ACNS 2026.
- AICrypt 2026. Organizer of an affiliated event at Eurocrypt 2026.
- Organizer for Dagstuhl seminar 'Divided We Stand: Security and Privacy of Collaborative Learning. 2026.
- Organizer for Shonan seminar Cutting-edge AI and Hardware Security. 2026.
- Tutorial chair for the Summer School on real-world crypto and privacy 2025, Dubrovnik (Croatia).
- Organizing committee member for the Summer School on real-world crypto and privacy 2025, Dubrovnik (Croatia).
- AICrypt 2025. Organizer of an affiliated event at Eurocrypt 2025.
- Tutorial chair for the Summer School on real-world crypto and privacy 2024, Vodice (Croatia).
- Organizing committee member for the Summer School on real-world crypto and privacy 2024, Vodice (Croatia).
- BFA 2024 general co-chair.
- AICrypt 2024. Organizer of an affiliated event at Eurocrypt 2024.
- AIHWS 2024. Organizer of an affiliated event at ACNS 2024.
- Tutorial chair for the Summer School on real-world crypto and privacy 2023, Vodice (Croatia).
- Organizing committee member for the Summer School on real-world crypto and privacy 2023, Vodice (Croatia).
- ACAI 2023. Organizer of an affiliated event at CRYPTO 2023.
- AICrypt 2023. Organizer of an affiliated event at Eurocrypt 2023.

- AIHWS 2023. Organizer of an affiliated event at ACNS 2023.
- CANS_AI 2022. Organizer of an affiliated event at CANS 2022.
- Organizer for Dagstuhl seminar Intelligent Security: Is "AI for Cybersecurity" a Blessing or a Curse.
- AIHWS 2022. Organizer of an affiliated event at ACNS 2022.
- AICRYPT 2022. Organizer of an affiliated event at Eurocrypt 2022.
- AICRYPT 2021. Organizer of an affiliated event at Eurocrypt 2021.
- AIHWS 2021. Organizer of an affiliated event at ACNS 2021.
- Eurocrypt 2021 general co-chair.
- BEADO. Organizer of a Special session at CEC 2020.
- Intelligent and Secure? The threat of artificial intelligence without security. Organizer of a Special session at DAC 2020.
- AIHWS 2020. Organizer of an affiliated event at ACNS 2020.
- Organizer for Lorentz workshop AI+Sec: Artificial Intelligence and Security, Leiden, 2019.
- Eurocrypt 2020 general co-chair.
- Mathematical Foundations of Cybersecurity workshop, Heidelberg Laureate Forum 2018.
- Summer school on Real world crypto and privacy, Sibenik, Croatia, 2014–2022.

University Service

- Member of a Board for Evaluating the Support for the Outgoing International Mobility, University of Zagreb Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computing, Croatia, 2026–2029.
- Member of a Board for Science and Innovation, University of Zagreb Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computing, Croatia, 2025–2026.
- External Examiner/Advisor for Bachelor of Information Technology (Honours) Computer Engineering, UTAR, Malaysia, 2025–2026.
- Trustworthy AI Group leader, Selmer Center in Secure Communication, University of Bergen, Norway, 2025–2028.
- Master coordinator for the Erasmus+ Programme “Erasmus Mundus Artificial Intelligence”, Radboud University, 2022–2026.
- Master coordinator for the specialization program “Cybersecurity and AI”, Radboud University, 2022–present.
- SIG-CS, TU Delft representative, 2020–2022.
- AISyLab founder and leader, TU Delft/Radboud University, 2020–present (www.aisylab.com).
- Cyber Security specialization master coordinator, TU Delft, 2020–2021.
- Moonshot lifelong learning, TU Delft, 2019–2020.
- Cyber Security Group Seminar organizer, TU Delft, 2018–2021.
- TU Delft representative in European Energy Information Sharing and Analysis Center: EE-ISAC. 2017–2020.

Funding

EU, 2025. HORIZON Innovation Actions, “SHASAI - Secure Hardware and Software for AI systems”. Consortium member, Total project EUR 6 000 000, Radboud funding ≈ EUR 500 000.

Research Council of Norway, 2024. “Cryptographic Elements of Trustworthy AI”. Co-applicant, NOK 14 945 000 ($\approx$ EUR 1 276 193).

EU, 2024. Erasmus+, “CipherEngine: Fostering computational thinking via cryptographic methods for interdisciplinary STEAM education”. Principal investigator, EUR 400 000.

The Dutch Research Council, 2023. Gravitation 2023, “Challenges in Cyber Security”. Consortium member, total value of the grant for the whole consortium EUR 21 568 150.

The Dutch Research Council, 2023. Open Technology Programme, “BASES: Bio-inspired Advanced Security Testing for Embedded Systems”. Co-applicant, total in-cash value EUR 818 374.

EU, 2023. Erasmus Mundus joint Master, “EMAI: Erasmus Mundus joint Master in Artificial Intelligence”. Co-applicant, total value EUR 3 000 000.

The Dutch Research Council, 2022. Take-off feasibility grant. Principal investigator, EUR 40 000.

The Dutch Research Council, 2021. Take-off feasibility grant. Principal investigator, EUR 40 000.

The Dutch Research Council, 2021–2025. “PROACT – Physical Attack Resistance of Cryptographic Algorithms and Circuits with Reduced Time to Market”. Co-applicant. EUR 1 800 000.

The Dutch Research Council, 2021–2025. “DISTANT - Defending against Implementation attackS Through mAchiNe learning Techniques”. Principal investigator. EUR 456 000.

TKI Grant, 2019. EUR 200 000.

GAIA, 2019–2023. “GAIA - Genetic Algorithms for Implementation Attacks”. Principal investigator. EUR 300 000. Industry funding, funded by STMicroelectronics, France.

Croatian Science Foundation, 2014–2018. “EVOCRYPT - Evolutionary Computation and Cryptography”. Co-applicant. EUR 80 000.

Additionally, I received grants and scholarships for more than 25 events in a total amount of more than EUR 50 000.

Teaching

Classes

The courses that I developed are given in bold font.

- 2025– Machine Learning 1, University of Zagreb, Croatia.
- 2024– Introduction to Artificial Intelligence, University of Zagreb, Croatia.
- 2021– Computer System Security, Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computing, Zagreb, Croatia (joint with M. Golub).
- 2023– **AI and Security seminar**, Radboud University, The Netherlands.
- 2023– **Advanced Topics in Computer Science: Security and Privacy of Machine Learning**, University of Padova, Italy.
- 2022– **Security and Privacy of Machine Learning**, Radboud University, The Netherlands.
- 2020– Technical Measurements and Interventions, Cyber Security Academy, The Netherlands.

- 2019–2023 **Algebra and Cryptography**, bachelor level course, TU Delft, The Netherlands.
- 2019–2022 Seminar Science and Methods in Cyber security, TU Delft, The Netherlands.
- 2018–2022 Applied Security Analysis, TU Delft, The Netherlands.
- 2018–2019 **Foundations of Symmetric Key Cryptography**, Novosibirsk State University, Novosibirsk, Russia.
- 2018–2020 Applied Cryptography, Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computing, Zagreb, Croatia (joint with M. Golub).
- 2017–2023 **Systems Security**, TU Delft, The Netherlands (joint with A. Continella).
- 2015–2016 Advanced Operating systems, Faculty of Engineering, Rijeka, Croatia.

Teaching/Management Skills

- 2026 Finished PhD supervision programme, Radboud University.
- 2023 Finished academic leadership programme, Radboud University.
- 2023 Finished University Teaching Qualification programme, Radboud University. <https://www.ru.nl/en/staff/lecturers/lecturer-development/university-teaching-qualification-utq>

Supervision

- PhD Tom Jansen, 2026–, Radboud University.
- Mihael Marovic, 2026–, University of Zagreb.
- Brahim Mamad, 2025–, Radboud University (joint supervision with Lejla Batina).
- Jona te Lintel, 2025–, Radboud University.
- Lizzy Grootjen, 2025–, Radboud University (joint supervision with Lejla Batina).
- Emre Balci, 2024–, University of Bergen, Norway
- David Perez, 2024–present, Radboud University, The Netherlands.
- Roberto Riano, 2024–present, Radboud University, The Netherlands.
- Sengim Karayalçin, 2023–present, Leiden University, The Netherlands (joint supervision with Marina Krcek).
- Abraham Basuto, 2022–present, Radboud University.
- Behrad Tajalli, 2021–present, Radboud University.
- Stefanos Koffas, 2021–present, TU Delft (joint supervision with Mauro Conti).
- Finished Azade Rezaeezade, 2021–2026, TU Delft (joint supervision with Lejla Batina). Now postdocotoral researcher at Radboud University, The Netherlands.
- Xiaoyun Xu, 2022–2026, Radboud University. Now assistant professor at the Zhongguancun Academy, China)
- Leo Weissbart, 2018–2025, TU Delft, The Netherlands (joint supervision with Lejla Batina). Now researcher at NTU Singapore.
- Mujtaba Hassan, 2021–2025, KU Leuven, Belgium (joint supervision with Nele Mentens).
- Gorka Abad, 2021–2025, Radboud University. Now postdoctoral researcher at University of Bergen, Norway.
- Marina Krcek, 2019–2024, TU Delft. Now postdoctoral researcher at Radboud University, The Netherlands.
- Jing Xu, 2019–2024, TU Delft, The Netherlands. Now proleptic lecturer at University of York, UK.

	Huimin Li, 2019–2024, TU Delft, The Netherlands. Now assistant professor at Shenzhen University of Advanced Technology, China.
	Lichao Wu, 2019–2023, TU Delft, The Netherlands. Now assistant professor at the University of Bristol, UK.
	Zakaria Najm, 2018–2023, TU Delft, The Netherlands. Now technical lead at Nestria AI, Singapore.
	Karlo Knezevic, 2016–2023, University of Zagreb, Croatia. Now head of AI at Sofascore, Croatia.
Current postdoctoral researchers	Marina Krcek, Ermes Franch, Gorka Abad.
Previous postdoctoral researchers	Luca Mariot (now assistant professor at the University of Twente, The Netherlands), Guilherme Perin (now at the ADP Brazil labs, Brazil), Oguzhan Ersoy (now at the Gensyn company, UK), Lichao Wu (now assistant professor at the University of Bristol, UK), Xiaoyun Xu (now assistant professor at the Zhongguancun Academy, China).
Other	More than 100 finished bachelor and master student supervisions.
Awards that students received:	Aliza Reif received the KHMW Young Talent Graduation Award for Data Science 2025. Coen Schoof received the KHMW Young Talent Graduation Award for Data Science 2024. Lichao Wu received the MDPI Informatics Best PhD Thesis Award for 2023.

Selected Professional Memberships

IEEE Senior member, ACM member, IACR member, EurAI member, ELLIS member.

Selected Software Contributions

- Backdoor Pony (2022). This framework enables attack and defense analysis for backdoor attacks on neural networks. Tool presented at Black hat Asia 2023.
- AISY (2021). This framework enables deep learning-based side-channel analysis. Tool presented at Black hat Asia 2022.
- MOVE (2018). This software simulates adversarial dynamics for network security through co-evolutionary algorithms.
- GET (2014). This software enables evaluating the Boolean function and S-box properties in cryptography.

Keynotes/Invited Talks/Panels

- 2026 PPSN tutorial “AI for Security, Security for AI: Practical Methods and Research Frontiers”, Italy.
- 2026 Invited speaker for the IEEE ERAS Workshop, Croatia.
- 2026 GECCO tutorial “The Co-Evolution of AI and Cybersecurity: Attacks, Defenses, and Future Directions”, Costa Rica.
- 2026 Invited lecture for the hack::soho “Safety-Neuron-Based Attacks on LLMs”. London, UK.
- 2026 Invited lecture for the Workshop on Topics in Advanced Areas of Cryptology (TAAC). Virtual.

- 2026 Invited lecture for the 1st MMU–UTAR Post-Quantum Cryptography Symposium: Standards, Engineering, and Applications. Virtual.
- 2026 Panelist for the 1st MMU–UTAR Post-Quantum Cryptography Symposium: Standards, Engineering, and Applications. Virtual.
- 2025 Invited lecture for Third Croatian Symposium on Artificial Intelligence, Zagreb, Croatia.
- 2025 Invited lecture for Young Academy of Europe. Virtual.
- 2025 Panelist for the International Centre of Excellence for OSINT roundtable, Zagreb, Croatia.
- 2025 Keynote speaker at the A2-Week Engineering Conclave 2025 - Rethinking Engineering Futures, Stanley College of Engineering & Technology for Women, Hyderabad, India. Virtual.
- 2025 Invited speaker at the Trustworthy AI - CUSO School, Neuchatel, Switzerland.
- 2025 Tutorial “Leaky ML: Physical Attacks on EdgeML Devices”, CHES 2025, Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia.
- 2025 Tutorial speaker at the Selected Areas in Cryptography conference summer school, Toronto, Canada.
- 2025 Invited speaker at the Selected Areas in Cryptography conference, Toronto, Canada.
- 2025 Invited speaker at the PROACT Training School, Crete, Greece.
- 2025 Invited speaker at the ASCI school - A29 Hardware and System Security course, Utrecht, The Netherlands.
- 2025 Invited speaker at the OPTIMIST workshop. Virtual.
- 2025 Keynote speaker at the DataFocus conference, Zagreb, Croatia.
- 2024 Keynote speaker at the Workshop on AI for Cyber Threat Intelligence, Hawaii, USA.
- 2024 Invited speaker at the European Cyber Week, Rennes, France.
- 2024 Panelist for the Open Societies Masterclass: Is AI a threat or a blessing for security and democracy?, Utrecht, The Netherlands.
- 2024 Keynote speaker at conference “Artificial Intelligence in Cyber Security”, 2024, Osijek, Croatia.
- 2024 Tutorial speaker at BFA 2024, Dubrovnik, Croatia.
- 2024 Invited speaker at End-of-ESCADA Workshop, 2024, Nijmegen, The Netherlands.
- 2024 Tutorial speaker at workshop on security of AI, Oslo, Norway.
- 2024 Invited speaker at Korean workshop on AI and cybersecurity, Seoul, South Korea.
- 2024 Invited speaker at ISCAS 2024 Embedded Workshops on Hardware Security, Singapore.
- 2024 Keynote speaker at ISC virtual school on “Security and AI”.
- 2023 Keynote speaker at the NORCICS 2023, Trondheim, Norway.
- 2023 Lecturer at the ASCI Winterschool on Deep Learning, Oegstgeest, The Netherlands.
- 2023 Tutorial speaker at Indocrypt conference, Goa, India.

- 2023 Panelist for the Fifth AMSec Workshop: How do we unite cybersecurity and artificial intelligence?, Amsterdam, The Netherlands.
- 2023 Invited speaker at CROSSING Conference 2023, Darmstadt, Germany.
- 2023 Panelist for the Glowing Hot Topics in Cryptography Workshop, Santa Barbara, USA.
- 2023 Invited speaker for the International Hardware Security Forum (Building Secure Systems Bottom Up: Devices to Systems), Kyoto, Japan.
- 2023 Invited speaker at PROACT Training school, Vodice, Croatia.
- 2023 Invited speaker at Security Summit New Work SE, Hamburg, Germany.
- 2023 Invited speaker at School on Applied Cryptography, Bangkok, Thailand.
- 2022 Invited speaker at International Winter School on Microarchitectural Security 2022 Paris, France.
- 2022 Invited speaker at CANS_AI 2022 Abu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates.
- 2022 Invited speaker at SUSHI: Sustainable Hardware Security 2022, San Diego, USA.
- 2022 Tutorial “Deep Learning-based Side-channel Analysis”, CHES 2022, Leuven, Belgium.
- 2022 Invited speaker at BFA 2022, Balestrand, Norway.
- 2022 Invited speaker at Vernam Lab’s Midsummer Workshop on Hardware Security, Worcester, USA.
- 2022 Tutorial “Deep Learning-based Side-channel Analysis” at the Summer School on real-world crypto and privacy, Sibenik, Croatia.
- 2022 GECCO tutorial “Evolutionary Computation and Machine Learning in Security”, Boston, USA.
- 2022 Keynote speaker at the 5th IEEE Conference on Dependable and Secure Computing (IEEE DSC 2022), Edinburgh, UK.
- 2022 Invited speaker at the International Winter School on “Cyber Security and Threat Intelligence”, India.
- 2021 Panelist for Hardware: Security’s Frontier . . . Research Use Cases and Ideas 2021.
- 2021 Invited speaker at Secure Design Strategies For Intelligent CPUs Workshop (SecSI) 2021 workshop.
- 2021 Invited speaker at 2nd Workshop on Evolutionary and Population-based Optimization (WEPO) workshop, 2021.
- 2021 Invited speaker at Virtual OpenS3 Workshop 2021.
- 2021 Panelist for Fault Diagnosis and Tolerance in Cryptography 2021 (topic: Electromagnetic Disturbance in the Industry).
- 2021 Panelist at Alice and Eve 2021 (AI & Me: The Good, The Bad and The Ugly), Nijmegen, The Netherlands.
- 2021 Invited speaker at CROSSING Conference 2021, Darmstadt, Germany.
- 2021 Panelist at High-Tech Women in Science and Technology Darmstadt, Germany.
- 2020 Keynote speaker at ICT Innovations Conference 2020, Skopje, Republic of North Macedonia.
- 2020 GECCO tutorial “Evolutionary computation and machine learning in cryptology”.

- 2019 Invited speaker at CPS Security Workshop, Indian Institute of Technology Kharagpur, India.
- 2019 Invited speaker at 9th International Conference on Security, Privacy, and Applied Cryptographic Engineering, SPACE 2019, Gandhinagar, India.
- 2019 Invited speaker at CROSSING Summer School on Sustainable Security & Privacy, Darmstadt, Germany.
- 2019 Invited speaker at Machine Learning and Security School, Padua, Italy.
- 2019 Workshop on side-channel attacks, Sibenik, Croatia.
- 2019 Invited speaker at HiPEAC SeHAS: Secure Hardware, Architectures, and Operating Systems workshop, Valencia, Spain.
- 2018 Invited speaker at Australian Summer School on Embedded Cryptography, Adelaide, Australia.
- 2018 Invited speaker at Cryptacus COST Action Final Conference, Rennes, France.
- 2018 Invited speaker at CryptoIC conference 2018, Beijing, China.
- 2018 PPSN tutorial “Evolutionary Computation in Cryptology”.
- 2018 Machine Learning tutorial, NXP, Hamburg, Germany.
- 2017 GECCO tutorial “Evolutionary Computation in Cryptology”.
- 2016 Invited speaker at Workshop on Computer-Aided Design and Implementation for Cryptography and Security (CADICS) 2016, Austin, Texas USA.
- 2016 GECCO tutorial “Evolutionary Computation in Cryptology”.
- 2016 PPSN tutorial “Evolutionary Computation in Cryptology”.
- 2016 Invited speaker at Trudevice Training School on Trustworthy Manufacturing and Utilization of Secure Devices. Leukerbad, Switzerland, 2016.
- 2016 Invited speaker at WISA 2016 conference, Jeju Island, South Korea.
- 2016 Invited speaker at IPICS Academic Summer School, Leuven, Belgium, 2016.

Additionally, I gave seminar talks:

1. Academia: Telecom ParisTech, France; Masaryk University, Czech Republic; Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computing, Croatia; ETH Zurich, Switzerland; Bauhaus University, Germany; KU Leuven Technologiecampus Gent, Belgium; Radboud University, The Netherlands; Università della Svizzera italiana, Switzerland; University of Dalhousie, Canada; Massachusetts Institute of Technology, USA; University of Kent, UK; University of Milan–Bicocca, Italy; NTU Singapore, Singapore; Université libre de Bruxelles, Belgium; University of Adelaide, Australia; University of Padova, Italy; Leiden University, The Netherlands; Graz University of Technology, Austria; University of Sannio, Italy; Istanbul University of Technology, Turkey; Shandong University, China; Ss. Cyril and Methodius University in Skopje, North Macedonia; University of Trieste, Italy; UCLA, USA; Mathematical Institute, Belgrade, Serbia; Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen, China.
2. Industry: Google, Mountain View, USA; Bosch, Renningen, Germany; Airbus Space and Defense, France; NXP Hamburg, Germany; STMicroelectronics, France; TII, Abu-Dhabi; Intel, USA; Qualcomm, Ireland; IBM, USA.

Selected Outreach and Press

- Invited guest for several daily shows at Croatian national TV - Otvoreno, Prometej, Globalna Hrvatska, Studio 4. 2026.
- Coverage of the articles “Large Language Lobotomy: Jailbreaking Mixture-of-Experts via Expert Silencing” and “GoodVibe: Security-by-Vibe for LLM-Based Code Generation” in ShortSpan.ai 2026.
- Interviewed for a Hunt & Hackett’s 2026 Trend Report, 2026.
- Interviewed several times for the Croatian National Television. 2026.
- Interviewed for a white paper “Algorithms vs. attackers: how AI strengthens cyber resilience” Link11, 2024.
- Co-authored (with Lejla Batina) an article for the “Data, Cybersecurity and Privacy” magazine, 2024.
- AISyLab selected as “Best AI-Powered Cybersecurity Solutions Provider - Western Europe”, Corporate Vision, 2022.
- Coverage of the article “Hand Me Your PIN! Inferring ATM PINs of Users Typing with a Covered Hand” in Bleeping Computer, Gigazine, unite.ai, Wired (Italian edition), Heimdal Security, Schneier on Security, etc. 2022.
- Invited guest for the radio show “Eye of Science” on Croatian National Radio. Topic: Cryptography and Security. 2015.
- Invited guest for the radio show “Eye of Science” on Croatian National Radio. Topic: Evolutionary Computation. 2014.

Publication Overview

- Over 200 refereed publications, h-index 47.
- <https://scholar.google.hr/citations?user=C1enS8IAAAAJ&hl=en>
- <https://dblp.org/pid/50/10230.html>